Don't Use expect When allow Is Sufficient



In this example, we *allowed* the :min_password_length message instead of *expecting* it. There are a couple of reasons for this choice:

- We prefer to use expect only when it reveals the purpose of the spec; here, the point is to check the return value of strong_enough?, not to check that we queried a specific configuration option.
- If you use expect in a before hook, an unreceived message means that *every* example in the context will fail, obscuring their actual behavior.

Paradoxically, introducing fake behavior improved the *correctness* of these specs. After all, our definition of a correctly functioning password strength checker isn't "rejects passwords shorter than eight characters." It's "rejects passwords shorter than the configured length."

We can also see another happy result: by bringing in a test double, we've made the specs easier to understand. Our code examples now clearly indicate the connection between the sample passwords and the configuration setting.

It's not always this easy to construct a test environment. In the next section, we'll see an example that blurs the line between test subject and environment. This awkwardness in our test suite will surface a design issue in our code.

Stubject (Stubbing the Subject)

You may occasionally see a test case that uses allow or expect on the same object it's testing. Sam Phippen refers to this antipattern as the *stubject* code smell, since you're stubbing methods on the test subject.[1]

For example, consider the following code for a discussion forum that sends users a summary of what's happened over the past day:

15-using-test-doubles-effectively/03/daily_summary_email/lib/daily_summary.rb

```
class DailySummary
  def send_daily_summary(user_email, todays_messages)
    message_count = todays_messages.count
    thread_count  = todays_messages.map { |m| m[:thread_id] }.uniq.count
    subject       = 'Your daily message summary'
    body          = "You missed #{message_count} messages " \
                    "in #{thread_count} threads today"
```

1. https://samphippen.com/introducing-rspec-smells/#smell1stubject